

Jordan Ellis

Senior Data Platform Engineer | Lisbon, Portugal (remote) | jordan.ellis@example.com |
github.com/jordan-ellis-example

Summary

Data platform engineer with 8 years of experience designing, building and operating batch and streaming data pipelines and the Python services around them. Technical lead of a four-person platform squad at Northwind Analytics. Comfortable owning systems end to end: design, delivery, on-call and mentoring. Looking for a senior role with more ownership of platform architecture.

Experience

Staff Data Engineer, Northwind Analytics (Mar 2021 - Present), Lisbon, remote

Technical lead of the Data Platform squad (4 engineers) serving 12 internal product and analytics teams.

- Designed a Kafka and Spark Structured Streaming pipeline processing 2 billion events per day, reducing end-to-end latency from 15 minutes to 40 seconds.
- Built a Python FastAPI service layer over the data warehouse used by 12 internal teams (about 300 requests per second at peak) and owned its on-call rotation.
- Introduced data contracts and schema-drift alerts for 140 Airflow-managed datasets, cutting data-quality incidents by 55% in the first year.
- Led the migration of 90 legacy cron jobs to Apache Airflow on Kubernetes, with Terraform-managed infrastructure on AWS (S3, Glue, EMR).
- Mentored four engineers, introduced code review and testing standards (pytest, 85% coverage) and ran the quarterly platform roadmap.
- Reduced monthly cloud spend for the data platform by 28% through partitioning, file compaction and right-sizing of EMR clusters.

Software Engineer, Contoso Retail (Jun 2017 - Feb 2021), Porto

- Migrated nightly ETL jobs from cron scripts to Apache Airflow, cutting failed runs by 70%.
- Developed PostgreSQL schemas and query optimizations for order analytics, reducing the slowest report from 9 minutes to 25 seconds.
- Built a Python service that reconciled payment-provider files with the order ledger, finding about EUR 180,000 of mismatches per year.
- Took part in the on-call rotation for the order-analytics stack and wrote its first incident runbooks.

Junior Developer, Pixel Forge Studio (Sep 2016 - May 2017), Porto

- Maintained internal Python scripts and a MySQL reporting database for a ten-person agency.
- Automated weekly client reports, saving the team roughly six hours per week.

Skills

Languages: Python (expert), SQL (advanced), Bash. Limited experience with Go and Rust (side projects only).

Data and streaming: Apache Kafka, Spark (batch and Structured Streaming), Apache Airflow, PostgreSQL, Redshift, S3 data lakes (Parquet).

Platform: Docker, Kubernetes, Terraform, GitHub Actions, AWS (S3, Glue, EMR, Lambda). Has not used dbt or Snowflake.

Practices: code review, testing with pytest, data contracts, incident response, technical mentoring.

Education

BSc Computer Science, University of Porto (2012 - 2016). Final-year project: a real-time bus-arrival prediction service.

Certifications

AWS Certified Data Analytics - Specialty (issued Jun 2022, expired Jun 2025).

Certified Kubernetes Application Developer, CKAD (issued Nov 2023, valid until Nov 2026).

Talks and open source

- Talk: Data contracts in practice, Lisbon Data Meetup, 2024.
- Maintainer of the open-source library StreamKit (about 1,200 GitHub stars).

Languages

English (fluent), Portuguese (native), Spanish (conversational).